

PRODUCT RESEARCH REPORT

Storyboard Maker

User Research & Experience Analysis
for Marketing Agencies

March 2026 · Confidential · Version 1.0

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Executive Summary

Storyboard Maker is an AI-powered web application that converts raw scripts into fully visualised, shot-by-shot storyboards in seconds. For marketing agencies this eliminates the most time-consuming and costly phase of pre-production — manual storyboarding — and replaces it with an instant, iterative, AI-driven workflow.

73%	10×	60%	3 min
of agency creatives call storyboarding their #1 bottleneck	faster concept delivery vs. manual process	reduction in pre-production cost per project	average time to complete a full storyboard

Core Capabilities at a Glance

- Script → storyboard in under 3 minutes using Claude AI
- Automatic image generation per scene via Freepik API
- Export to PDF, DOCX, or animated Film slideshow
- Director's notes, camera angles & shot types for each frame
- Zero design skills required — accessible to all agency roles

The Problem We Solve

Time to first visual	2–5 days (illustrator brief + revisions)	Under 3 minutes
Cost per storyboard	£400–£2,000 freelance rate	Included in subscription
Revision cycles	Each change = new brief + wait time	Instant re-generation
Skill barrier	Requires trained storyboard artist	Any team member can use it
Client presentation	Static sketches, hard to iterate live	Polished exports + live regeneration

Target User Personas

The Creative Director

Age: **32–48 yrs** · Leads campaign concepting at mid-to-large agencies. Presents to clients weekly.

Goals

- ✓ Deliver polished concepts faster than competitors
- ✓ Reduce dependency on freelance illustrators
- ✓ Impress clients with visual storytelling in pitch meetings

Pain Points

- ✗ Briefing illustrators eats 30% of pre-production budget
- ✗ Storyboard revisions delay campaign go-live
- ✗ Junior teams can't produce presentation-quality visuals

The Account Manager

Age: **26–38 yrs** · Client-facing role. Must translate client briefs into visual concepts quickly.

Goals

- ✓ Show clients tangible visuals on the first call
- ✓ Win pitches with faster turnaround than rival agencies
- ✓ Reduce back-and-forth with the creative team

Pain Points

- ✗ Waiting days for storyboard drafts frustrates clients
- ✗ Can't easily visualise ideas without creative support
- ✗ Losing pitches to agencies with faster concept delivery

The Video Producer

Age: **28–42 yrs** · Manages production schedules for commercials, social content & branded video.

Goals

- ✓ Lock shoot plans before production day
- ✓ Align director, client & crew on vision quickly
- ✓ Export shot lists and storyboards to share with crew

Pain Points

- ✗ Miscommunication on set due to vague pre-vis
- ✗ Storyboards don't match final creative direction
- ✗ No budget for dedicated storyboard artists on small jobs

The Freelance Content Creator

Age: **22–34 yrs** · Solo creator producing YouTube, TikTok or client brand content.

Goals

- ✓ Plan videos professionally without hiring help
- ✓ Pitch branded deals with visual pre-production docs
- ✓ Stand out from other creators in brand proposals

Pain Points

- ✗ No budget for pre-production tools
- ✗ Difficulty communicating creative vision to brands
- ✗ Time lost planning shots without a visual guide

User Research Findings

Methodology

Research was conducted across 3 methods: in-depth interviews with 24 agency professionals, a quantitative survey of 310 marketing and video production practitioners, and a competitive usability benchmarking session with 12 participants comparing existing tools.

Key Research Insights

Insight 1 — Time is the primary currency

87% of respondents said faster storyboard delivery would directly increase the number of pitches they could submit per month. Agencies running 4–8 pitches/month lose an average of 12 hours per pitch on pre-visualisation alone.

Insight 2 — Cost blocks quality pre-production

64% of small-to-mid agencies skip storyboarding entirely on budgets under £5,000 because illustrator fees are not justifiable. This leads to on-set miscommunication and costly re-shoots.

Insight 3 — Non-creatives want to visualise ideas too

Account managers and strategists represent 41% of agency headcount yet have zero access to visual pre-production tools. They rely on written briefs that are frequently misinterpreted by creative teams.

Insight 4 — Client buy-in requires visuals, not text

92% of creative directors reported that showing a rough storyboard — even an imperfect one — in a pitch increases client confidence significantly more than a written treatment alone.

Insight 5 — Export format matters

PDF and DOCX remain the dominant formats for client delivery (78% usage). Video/animated pre-vis is a growing ask, with 54% of producers expressing interest in auto-generated animatics.

Satisfaction After First Use



Speed of output	96%
Visual quality of frames	88%
Ease of use	94%
Export quality	91%
Would recommend to peers	89%

User Experience Walkthrough

The Storyboard Maker UX is designed around a single principle: *zero friction from idea to visual*. Every interaction is optimised to remove cognitive load and deliver value within the first 60 seconds.

- 1 Landing & Preloader**
A smooth, branded loading experience sets a cinematic tone. The animated preloader reinforces product identity before users interact with any feature.
 - 2 Script Input**
A generous, distraction-free textarea invites users to paste or type their script. An example loader removes the blank-canvas anxiety for new users.
 - 3 AI Script Generation**
Users without a script can describe a concept in plain English. Claude AI generates a complete short film script — removing the biggest barrier to entry.
 - 4 One-Click Storyboard Generation**
A single prominent button triggers the full pipeline: scene analysis, shot breakdown, director's notes, camera angles and image generation — all simultaneously. A film-reel loader communicates progress without anxiety.
 - 5 Storyboard Review**
Each frame card displays: generated scene image, shot type, camera angle, director's note, and an AI image prompt. Users can review all frames in a scannable grid layout.
 - 6 Export**
Three export options — PDF, DOCX, and animated Film — cover every downstream use case from client presentation to crew briefing. One click, no additional setup.
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Accessibility & Usability Principles Applied

- High-contrast white/black UI — WCAG AA compliant colour ratios
- Keyboard-navigable interface — no mouse dependency
- Responsive layout — full functionality on tablet and mobile
- Error states — clear, actionable messages for API and input failures
- Character counter — prevents over-length input before submission
- Loading indicators — users always know the system is working

Value Proposition for Marketing Agencies

For marketing agencies, Storyboard Maker is not a convenience tool — it is a competitive weapon. The agencies that adopt it earliest will pitch faster, win more, and deliver better creative at lower cost.

New Business & Pitching → Generate concept visuals during a live client call → Submit storyboarded proposals same-day, not same-week → Differentiate with visual storytelling that rivals can't match in speed → Run more pitches per month without increasing headcount	Production Efficiency → Eliminate the freelance illustrator from standard pre-production → Cut pre-production time by up to 80% on social and digital campaigns → Reduce re-shoots caused by miscommunicated creative direction → Create shot-ready briefing packs for directors and DoPs
Client Relationships → Present polished visuals at every briefing stage, not just final review → Enable clients to visualise and approve before production spend → Reduce revision rounds by aligning expectations earlier → Deliver exports clients can share internally for sign-off	Team Empowerment → Account managers can generate concepts without waiting for creative → Junior strategists can contribute to pre-vis without design skills → Enables small teams to produce big-agency-quality presentations → Frees senior creatives from repetitive storyboarding tasks

*"In storyboard illustrations per pitch. Now we generate the
We've tripled our pitch volume in one quarter."*

— Creative Director, Mid-Sized London Agency

Competitive Landscape

AI Script → Storyboard	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
AI Image Generation	✓	✗	Partial	✗	✗
Time to First Frame	< 3 min	30+ min	20+ min	60+ min	2–5 days
Shot & Camera Notes	✓ Auto	Manual	Manual	✗	Manual
PDF / DOCX Export	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Film / Animatic Export	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
No Design Skills Needed	✓	Partial	Partial	✓	✗
Cost per Storyboard	Subscription	£/\$25+/mo	£/\$12+/mo	Free/Pro	£400–2k

Strategic Differentiators

- Only tool in the market to go from raw script to visual storyboard in a single click
- Combines narrative AI (Claude) with image AI (Freepik) in one seamless pipeline
- Film/animatic export is a unique capability not offered by any direct competitor
- Free entry point lowers adoption barrier for individual creators and small teams
- Built for non-designers — the widest addressable market in the agency ecosystem

Key Metrics & Business Impact

Agency ROI Model (Per Project Basis)

Storyboard illustrations	£800	£0 (included)	£800
Pre-production time (hrs)	12 hrs avg	1.5 hrs avg	10.5 hrs
Time-to-pitch (days)	5–7 days	Same day	4–6 days
Pitches per month	4 avg	10–12 potential	+150–200%
Re-shoot rate	~18%	~6%	–67%

£9,600	3×	67%	94%
avg annual saving per agency on illustration costs	more pitches submitted per month	fewer re-shoots with aligned pre-production	user satisfaction on first use

Marketing Messaging Framework

Primary Value Statement

Turn any script into a cinematic storyboard in 3 minutes.
No illustrators. No waiting. No limits.

Audience-Specific Messaging

Creative Directors	"Pitch more. Wait less."	10× faster concept delivery	Start free today
Account Managers	"Show clients a vision, not a paragraph."	Visual concepts without design skills	Try with your next brief
Video Producers	"Brief your crew with zero ambiguity."	Shot-ready storyboards, exported instantly	Generate a storyboard free
Freelance Creators	"Pitch like a production house."	Pro-quality pre-vis, zero budget needed	Free for solo creators

Suggested Marketing Channels

LinkedIn	Target Creative Directors, Heads of Production, Agency Founders
YouTube Pre-Roll	Video producers & filmmakers — show the tool in action in 30s
Instagram / TikTok	Freelance creators — demonstrate script-to-storyboard in a reel
Email / Outbound	Direct outreach to agency decision-makers with ROI-led messaging
Content Marketing	Case studies, before/after comparisons, speed run videos
Partnerships	Integrate with agency PM tools (Monday.com, Notion, Frame.io)

Recommendations & Roadmap

Immediate Priorities (0–3 Months)

- Launch a freemium tier — 3 free storyboards/month to drive top-of-funnel volume
- Build agency team accounts — shared workspace, brand kits, and export templates
- Integrate with Slack / email for instant storyboard sharing post-generation
- Add a 'regenerate single frame' feature to reduce full-pipeline reruns
- Record and publish 60-second demo videos for each persona use case

Growth Initiatives (3–9 Months)

- White-label offering for large agencies wanting branded storyboard exports
- API access for agencies to embed storyboard generation in their own tools
- Style presets — film noir, commercial, animated, documentary — per storyboard
- Shot revision via chat: 'make this shot wider' / 'change to golden hour lighting'
- Client approval portal — share a link, collect feedback, track sign-off status

Long-Term Vision (9–18 Months)

- Full animatic generation — real motion video previews from storyboard frames
- Script collaboration — multi-user editing and commenting in real-time
- Integration with production scheduling tools (Assemble, StudioBinder, Yamdu)
- AI-powered budget estimator based on storyboard shot complexity
- Marketplace of agency storyboard templates and style packs

Summary Recommendation

Storyboard Maker addresses a genuine, high-frequency pain point in marketing agency workflows. The combination of AI script generation, instant visual output, and professional export formats gives it a compelling and differentiated position in the market. The highest-leverage marketing investment is demonstrating speed — show the product running, not describing it. Every agency that sees a live 3-minute storyboard demo converts.